



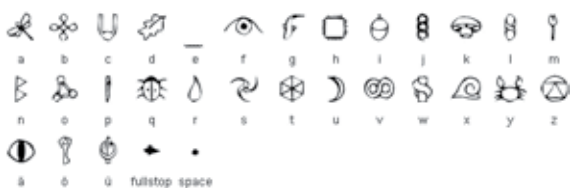
A new study just revealed that the average number of phone screens cracked every hour is a whopping 5,761. <https://dgit.in/dec18-114-2>

Some science fiction and fantasy worlds are so thoroughly built, that they even have complete fictional languages within them. A deliberately crafted fictional language is known as a constructed language - or a conlang. The absolute master of languages in fictional worlds is JRR Tolkien. Tolkien crafted the languages first, and even figured out how they evolved over time in a fictional universe, and then created the story around the languages. The languages were central to the story, not just some background information for additional world building. In this article, we are focusing on the scripts that you can actually learn and write with. They can have a variety of uses, including secret notes, personalised tattoos, fancy bookplates and gift labels. The good thing about learning the scripts is that you do not have to sit and listen to the Dothraki learning DVDs by HBO.



The Alien Alphabet used in *Futurama* is a straight up substitution cipher. This is the easiest to use for practical communication and letters, as it has a full set of numbers and all the necessary pronunciations. Fans deciphered the alphabet within half an hour of the show airing. The creators then released an Alien Alphabet 2, with more complicated rules.

Wakandan is an uncomplicated script created specifically for Black Panther. There are no punctuations, but there are small and capital variations of the letters, as well as all the numbers. As such, this is one of the easier scripts to learn to write in, and useful as well. The entire script can be figured out by just watching the credit sequence. If you want to have some fun, try that as an exercise. The lettering style is a mixture of tribal and futuristic. Like many other languages on this list, there is a real-world alternative to Wakandan as well. The script is based on Nsibidi.

[illegible]

Gnomish from *Artemis Fowl* is an easy language to learn to read, as it is a simple substitution cipher. There are two extra alphabets, no numbers, no capitals, and only two pronunciation marks. A special rule is that the letter E is written below the word that it follows, which is a subtle shout out to the more advanced conlangs, such as the ones crafted by Tolkien. Learning this script will allow you to understand the hidden clues that run along the bottom of the *Artemis Fowl* books.